SELECTED CASE STUDIES

LOYALTY & LIFECYCLE MARKETING

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Senior Marketing Leader building customer loyalty and lifecycle growth engines across hospitality, QSR, telecommunications, consumer products, and affinity marketing.

The five case studies that follow document real programs, real customer data, and real business outcomes. Client and company identities have been anonymized to honor confidentiality agreements — the strategy, thinking, and results are unchanged.

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Figures reflect actual program performance. Company names, brand identities, and select financial specifics have been withheld or generalized.

The Practice

Most of these programs were built before the playbook existed. The work is the same across every industry: turn scattered customer data into a system leadership can invest in with confidence — then prove it back in retention, lifetime value, and revenue.

15+	5	$3.75M+	30%
YEARS IN LOYALTY & LIFECYCLE MARKETING	INDUSTRIES — HOSPITALITY TO TELECOM	COMBINED MARKETING BUDGETS OPTIMIZED	HIGHEST ROI GAIN DELIVERED ON SPEND

01

Lifecycle Strategy

Mapping the full customer journey and building the segmentation, forecasting, and testing frameworks that turn behavior data into a growth roadmap.

02

Loyalty Architecture

Designing programs and value propositions from the ground up — or repositioning stalled ones — so loyalty functions as a growth engine, not a retention afterthought.

03

Data & Personalization

Translating customer insight and AI-driven personalization into experiences that feel individual, even at a multi-brand or global scale.

04

Cross-Functional Alignment

Getting Product, Sales, Customer Success, and executive leadership aligned around one shared definition of customer growth.

INDUSTRIES REPRESENTED IN THE FOLLOWING CASE STUDIES

- Affinity Marketing
- Multi-Brand Restaurant / QSR
- Global Consumer Products
- Telecommunications
- Global Hospitality

Building the Loyalty Function From Zero

1st	4	$MM
ENTERPRISE LOYALTY & ENGAGEMENT FRAMEWORK FOR THE ORGANIZATION	DEPARTMENTS ALIGNED AROUND THE NEW FRAMEWORK	MULTI-YEAR LOYALTY INVESTMENT DIRECTED & TIED TO LTV

THE DECISION

Two ways to start: launch a visible pilot fast to bank an early win, or spend the first quarter building the measurement infrastructure with nothing to show for it yet. Chose infrastructure first — a bet that a program without forecasting and segmentation underneath it would earn short-term praise and long-term budget cuts. That meant defending an unfamiliar roadmap to a leadership team used to seeing campaign results, not frameworks.

THE CHALLENGE

A national affinity marketing organization had grown for years without a formal loyalty or lifecycle marketing function. There was no retention framework, no structured referral engine, and no way to forecast the return on member engagement investment.

THE APPROACH

Mapped the member journey end-to-end to diagnose exactly where retention and referral value was being left on the table. Built the organization's first forecasting, segmentation, and testing frameworks, turning raw member data into a business case leadership could act on.

Ran the build as a cross-functional working group rather than a marketing-only project — weekly syncs with Product, Sales, Digital, and Customer Service so loyalty was designed into the member experience from the start, not layered on top of it later.

THE OUTCOME

Delivered the organization's first enterprise loyalty strategy and member engagement framework — now the operating foundation for retention, referral, and forecasting work going forward. Directed planning for a multimillion-dollar loyalty investment explicitly aligned to customer lifetime value.

Along the way: the first segmentation model leaned on tenure and didn't match leadership's gut sense of who the best members actually were. Rebuilt it around recency and referral behavior instead — the version that ultimately earned buy-in.

ROLE

Loyalty Marketing Manager — sole strategic owner; reported to executive leadership on program economics

Client identity anonymized

One Framework, Five Brands: Scaling Loyalty Across a National Portfolio

+17% CUSTOMER LIFETIME VALUE	+30% LOYALTY PROGRAM PARTICIPATION	+21% REVENUE GROWTH, +15PT VS. BENCHMARK	+20% DIGITAL SATISFACTION VIA AI PERSONALIZATION

THE DECISION

Standardizing five brands risked flattening what made each one distinct — a real objection from brand leads who'd built loyal followings on brand-specific quirks. Rejected a single shared loyalty experience in favor of "one engine, five front doors": one segmentation and lifecycle backbone underneath, with brand teams keeping control of creative, tone, and reward structure on top. It meant a longer build and a harder sell to shared-services stakeholders asked to give up control of messaging cadence for infrastructure they hadn't asked for.

THE CHALLENGE

Five restaurant brands under one parent company were each running loyalty and lifecycle marketing independently — different segmentation logic, different personalization maturity, no shared standard for what "good" looked like.

THE APPROACH

Architected the shared framework, then led a cross-brand working group of loyalty and CRM leads from all five brands to co-design how it flexed per brand. Layered in AI-driven personalization to sharpen relevance at scale, and identified co-marketing opportunities no single brand could access alone.

THE OUTCOME

Customer lifetime value rose 17% and loyalty participation climbed 30%. Co-marketing partnerships drove 21% revenue growth, beating benchmarks by 15 points; AI personalization lifted digital satisfaction 20%.

Along the way: the two largest brands adopted fast; two smaller brands resisted, reading the framework as pressure to look like the flagship. Slowed their rollout a quarter to co-design brand-specific reward logic rather than force the original timeline.

ROLE

Enterprise Loyalty & Customer Marketing Manager — led cross-brand working group; owned the AI personalization budget case to the CMO

Client identity anonymized

Turning a Stalled Loyalty Program Into a Growth Engine

+18% ENGAGEMENT & REVENUE	+27% ROI ON A ~$750K MARKETING INVESTMENT	+25% MARKET SHARE, VIA UNTAPPED SEGMENTS	EMEA NEW REGION ADDED TO PROGRAM FOOTPRINT

THE DECISION

The program had drifted for years, and some stakeholders wanted it killed and the budget redirected to pure acquisition. Made the case to rebuild instead — a bet that the existing enrolled base held retained value a competitor couldn't easily replicate, even if it wasn't showing up in the numbers yet. That meant defending a program people had already written off, on a flat budget, with no case for new investment until the redesign proved itself.

THE CHALLENGE

An established loyalty program had lost strategic relevance. Its value proposition no longer matched how consumers actually wanted to engage with the brand, and the marketing budget behind it wasn't earning its keep.

THE APPROACH

Redesigned the value proposition, engagement strategy, and cross-channel activation around evolving consumer needs, then rebuilt budget allocation around performance data instead of legacy spend patterns. Used competitive and customer insight to identify underserved segments worth pursuing directly.

Worked as an external contractor directing a full-time brand team's loyalty strategy — earned credibility with a regular review cadence alongside the brand VP rather than asking for authority upfront.

THE OUTCOME

Engagement and revenue both rose 18%. Reallocating the marketing investment lifted ROI 27%, and targeting previously untapped segments expanded market share 25%. The redesigned program's performance built the case to take it beyond its original footprint — leadership approved expansion into EMEA, extending the model to a new region.

Along the way: the first redesign leaned on discount-driven rewards, which won back lapsed members but cannibalized margin. Shifted to a non-discount, tiered value proposition built on access and experience instead — better margin, and it matched what re-engaged members actually wanted.

ROLE

Senior Brand Manager, Loyalty Program (engagement basis) — directed strategy for a full-time brand team as an external contractor

Client identity anonymized

Modernizing Lifecycle Marketing for the Omnichannel Era

+16%	+22%	+27%
CONVERSIONS	ENGAGEMENT FROM NEW LIFECYCLE STRATEGY	ENGAGEMENT ACROSS OMNICHANNEL CAMPAIGNS

THE DECISION

The legacy CRM ran on static, rule-based segmentation with heavy manual QA — the clean fix was a full replatform, but that meant a multi-quarter IT project with real delivery risk. Chose to layer automation and personalization on top of the existing stack instead. It was the faster, lower-risk path, but it meant designing around real technical constraints — limited real-time data feeds — rather than the system a from-scratch rebuild would have allowed.

THE CHALLENGE

CRM and lifecycle marketing infrastructure hadn't kept pace with customer expectations. Campaigns were largely manual and minimally personalized, and execution was too slow to act on customer behavior in real time.

THE APPROACH

Worked directly with CRM and engineering leads to scope what automation was actually feasible within the existing platform, then rebuilt customer journeys around behavioral segmentation rather than static lists.

Streamlined the campaign production process end-to-end, cutting execution time and freeing the team to test more — and react faster.

THE OUTCOME

Conversions rose 16% and engagement climbed 22% on the new lifecycle strategies. Coordinated omnichannel campaigns lifted engagement 27%, with materially shorter execution timelines.

Along the way: the first automated triggers over-sent — frequency wasn't capped tightly enough, and opt-outs spiked. Rebuilt the suppression and frequency logic, which brought unsubscribes back down without giving up the engagement gains.

ROLE

Brand Manager, Lifecycle Customer Marketing (engagement basis) — presented the build-vs-replatform case to marketing operations leadership

Client identity anonymized

Scaling Global Loyalty Without Losing the Local Touch

+30%	+25%	3%
MEMBER ENGAGEMENT, INTERNATIONAL BASE	CUSTOMER SATISFACTION	MONTHLY ENROLLMENT GROWTH, SUSTAINED

THE DECISION

Headquarters wanted one global template for consistency; regional teams pushed back that a single standard would flatten what worked market to market. Chose an adaptive model instead — one global backbone, with regional flexibility on redemption partners and communication cadence. It was more work upfront, building regional playbooks instead of one deck, and it meant pushing back on HQ's instinct for a single global rollout.

THE CHALLENGE

A global loyalty program needed to grow engagement and satisfaction across a highly diverse, international member base — without defaulting to a one-size-fits-all approach that tends to break down at that scale.

THE APPROACH

Directed global loyalty initiatives grounded in customer behavior insight, coordinating with regional marketing leads across multiple geographies rather than dictating strategy from the center. Introduced digital training and UX tools to accelerate adoption, internally and among members.

Automated lifecycle campaigns to sustain enrollment momentum without adding manual overhead across markets.

THE OUTCOME

Engagement grew 30% and satisfaction rose 25% across the international member base. Automated lifecycle campaigns sustained 3% month-over-month enrollment growth.

Along the way: the digital training rollout assumed uniform device access; several markets had lower staff smartphone penetration and adoption lagged. Built a lightweight print-based alternative alongside the digital tools, which brought those markets back in line.

ROLE

Associate Global Brand Manager, Loyalty Program — coordinated regional leads across geographies; reported to global brand leadership

Client identity anonymized

LET'S BUILD THE NEXT ONE

Every program here started the same way — a business without a growth system, and a leader willing to build one.

If your organization needs its first loyalty framework, or a stalled program needs a reason to matter again, that's the conversation worth having.

PLATFORMS & TOOLS

Salesforce Marketing Cloud · Braze · HubSpot · Pardot · Campaign Monitor · MailChimp · Google Analytics · Power BI

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Case studies anonymized to protect client confidentiality. Available to walk through additional context in conversation.